options. Sino-Indian relations, similarly, affected US options in Asia. But more than that, US and Indian policies toward each other were in no small part derivative of their China policy. This came with both risks and rewards.

When the US and India were on the same page in terms of envisioning a key role for the other in their China policies in particular and in their overall strategy, it could result in major benefits. It could make the other country useful and thus important. This meant not just assistance or cooperation but also greater tolerance for differences and willingness to make exceptions for the other. However, if Delhi's and Washington's China perceptions or policies did not match, it could be a serious subject of disagreement between the two countries. There was another risk for the US and India: if the utility of the other country and engagement with it were linked to China policy, then either country falling short of its expected role or changing its China policy could undermine the basis of engagement—a lesson Delhi learned the hard way in 1971 and one that shapes its concerns about a G-2 to this day.

Thus it is important to avoid the risk of the US-India relationship largely or primarily becoming derivative of their China strategies. One way is for the governments to continue to nurture cooperation across a broad range of issues and not assume that China will naturally bring them together. Each country has to make itself important to the other side, but there is a risk to doing so in just one realm.

Now and in the future, the China-India-US triangle will be far more fateful than it was in the past—not just for the countries involved but for the broader region and, arguably, the world.

In some ways, we have turned 180 degrees. In the 1970s, the US was building up China and supporting its rise, China was encouraging an American naval presence in the Indian Ocean, and Canberra was calling for an Australia-China-Japan-US quadrilateral to limit Soviet dominance in the Asia-Pacific and Indian Ocean regions. In other ways, we have come full circle. The previous few US administrations have echoed the ideas that were part of Eisenhower's Asia strategy—seeing India as a contrast and counterbalance to China, and supporting its rise and its role in the region.

As Delhi and Washington envision the other as part of their China strategies, the history of the triangle is important to keep in mind. And as it